Universal Human Values — II · 21LEM202T

Unit 5 · Session 1 · SLO 1 — Solved Worksheet

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Unit – 5 : Session – 1 | Our Participation at Different Levels is Our Value

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

• Q1. 'OUR PARTICIPATION AT DIFFERENT LEVELS IS OUR VALUE': the value of any unit is its participation in the larger order — so my value as a human being is precisely what I contribute at each level I am part of: in the SELF (living with right understanding and right feeling), with the BODY (health and self-regulation), in the FAMILY (feelings of trust, respect, care...), in SOCIETY (just, fearlessness-promoting participation), and in NATURE (right utilisation and protection). Where my participation enriches the larger order, I am valuable; where it exploits, my value is negative. Hence value is not status or wealth but demonstrated participation.

• Q2. HUMAN VALUES ARE DEFINITE (as per Lecture 23) because they are rooted in what is EXISTENTIALLY FIXED: (a) co-existence is the reality — harmony is inherent, not invented; (b) the natural acceptance of every Self is the same, unchanging with time, place and person; (c) the needs of Self and Body are definite and distinguishable; (d) the feelings in relationship (trust to love) are definite in content and order; (e) the human goal (right understanding, prosperity, fearlessness, co-existence) is definite; (f) therefore conduct flowing from right understanding is definite — what is valuable does not vary with fashion, market or regime. Unlike man-made rules, values derived from reality cannot be otherwise.

• Q3. VALUE-BASED LIVING → MUTUAL HAPPINESS AND MUTUAL PROSPERITY at two levels: (1) at the level of BEHAVIOUR with human beings — when I live with trust, respect and care, the other's need of the Self is fulfilled and mine too; relationship gives mutual happiness, not transaction. (2) at the level of WORK with the rest of nature — when I produce and consume with right utilisation, nature is protected and enriched while my body's needs are fulfilled; this gives mutual prosperity (me prosperous, nature flourishing). Value-based living thus converts both behaviour and work from zero-sum extraction into mutual fulfilment.

• Q4. ONE VALUE I will practise this week: TRUST — specifically, evaluating my family members and classmates on their INTENTION rather than their competence. Practice: whenever irritation arises at someone's failure or mistake, I will pause and recall that their intention, like mine, is naturally acceptable; then respond with guidance instead of blame. I will observe the effect on my state (fearlessness vs suspicion) and on the relationship, and note it at the week's end.